



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2017/2018

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF
BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

AEN 101: AN INTRODUCTION TO THE GRAMMAR OF ENGLISH

DATE: Monday, 5th February 2018

TIME: 8.00 a.m. - 10.00 a.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer question ONE and any other TWO questions.

1. (Compulsory)

- (a) Clearly distinguish between open and closed word classes. (10 marks)
- (b) "The modal auxiliary is unique among verbs." Using examples, discuss its distinctive characteristics. (10 marks)
- (c) Illustrate both the phrasal and clausal functions of the prepositional phrase. (10 marks)

2. (a) Use the following words as instructed:

- (i) smart as an adjective and as an adverb.
- (ii) since as a preposition, an adverb and as conjunction.
- (iii) pretty as an intensifier and as an adjective.
- (iv) fast as a verb, an adjective and as an adverb. (10 marks)

- (b) Identify the phrases in the following sentence and state the function of each:
"Quite surprisingly, the new employee has proved immensely useful in the new station. (10 marks)

3. (a) Explain how you would identify adjectives using the morphological criterion.
(10 marks)
- (b) Using illustrations, show the difference in usage between attributive and predicative adjectives.
(10 marks)
4. Briefly explain the meaning of the following grammatical terms:
(a) Number
(b) Person
(c) Tense
(d) Object
(20 marks)
5. Identify any FIVE different types of words that can function as determiners and illustrate their usage.
(20 marks)



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2016/2017

SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS

AEN 101: AN INTRODUCTION TO THE GRAMMAR OF ENGLISH

DATE: Wednesday, 10th May 2017

TIME: 8.00 a.m. - 10.00 a.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

ANSWER QUESTION ONE AND ANY OTHER TWO

QUESTION ONE

a) Identify the major class and function of the underlined words in the sentences below.

- i) The lady we met was tall.
- ii) The idea sounds noble.
- iii) My effort to assist her was sincere but ineffective
- iv) She has danced well.
- v) Wow! You look terrific!

(5 Marks)

b) Name and state the function of the underlined phrases.

- i) The extremely young in spirit enjoy life.
- ii) His youngest son was born as recently as last week.
- iii) The boy has spoilt his reputation
- iv) Am disappointed with you.
- v) The baby was so very happy.

(5 Marks)

c) Write a sentence for each of the sentence elements below.

- i) SVOO
- ii) SVOC
- iii) SVC_s
- iv) SVOA
- v) SVC_o

(5 Marks)

Question Two

- a) Using appropriate examples show that morphemes, lexemes and sentence forms are the basic units of a semantic analysis (14 marks)
- b) Explain three felicity conditions that an illocutionary act has to fulfill to achieve its effect. (6 marks)

Question Three

- a) Using appropriate examples, distinguish between sense denotation and reference (12 marks)
- b) Using examples, discuss the different classes of antonyms in languages (8 marks)

Question Four

- a) Define the term politeness as used in pragmatics. (4 marks)
- b) Explain ways in which Brown and Levinson's (1987) politeness can save face for others in an interaction (16 marks)

Question Five

- a) Explain how Grice's (1975) cooperative principles can be flouted in a conversation (12 marks)
- b) Use the componential analysis technique to distinguish the meaning of the word 'man' from 'mare'. (8 marks)



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2011/2012

SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF ARTS AND BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

AEN 101: INTRODUCTION TO THE DESCRIPTION OF ENGLISH

DATE: MONDAY 2ND APRIL 2012

TIME: 4.30 P.M. – 6.30 P.M.

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer question 1 and any other two questions.

1. Use the passage given below to answer questions (a) – (d)

1 One fine afternoon a man went to the local market to buy some meat for his family. When he reached the market, he went straight to the butcheries. *He looked at the meat that was displayed in these shops but didn't like what he saw.* In one, the meat was too fatty. In another, it was too lean. The third butchery didn't have any fresh meat and, in the last one which had just been opened, the butcher's working overalls was splattered all over with dried blood, he wore open dirty shoes, his hair was unkempt besides the fact that he was quite rude to other customers. As a consequence, the man did not buy any meat from these butcheries. He decided to buy a goat instead. He would take the meat home. It would be slaughtered by his workers. And there would be meat for the family for a long time.

9 After the purchase, the man did not know how to take the goat home. He decided to carry it under his arm but it was too heavy. He slung it over his shoulders but in hot afternoon sun, this made it even heavier. Holding the goat with a short rope he had bought it with, he sat under a tree by the roadside and began to think. Passersby saw him sitting under a tree but still holding onto the goat and wondered what was going on. At long last, he decided that he would go back to the market which was only a short distance away. He would have the goat slaughtered in one of the butcheries. Then he would carry the goat as meat home.

15 Still the man was faced with another dilemma. How would he carry the meat?

Again, he tried to hold it under his arms, but it was still too heavy. He carried it on his head but passersby were staring strangely at him. Two passersby advised him to tie the goat with a rope and pull it home. Not thinking at all, the now tired man did as he had been told. He was not aware that the two people were rogues. As he walked home dragging the meat behind him the rogues began to quietly chop off pieces from the meat. The man was too tired to pay any attention to what was holding the meat back as he pulled it behind him. When he arrived home, his family was very excited to see him. As he presented the meat to the family, it turned out to be just a big bone with a few scrapes of meat on it. What had happened to the meat? *The rogues had cut off the meaty parts piece by piece. They had left only a big bone and some sinewy scraps of meat on it.* There would be no dish of meat at all that night. The man felt very sad and terribly tired. He would be more careful next time.

- (a) Underline the words that belong to the closed class of items in the following sentence from the passage: (5 marks)

The third butchery didn't have any fresh meat and, in the last one which had just been opened, the butcher's working overalls was splattered all over with dried blood, he wore open dirty shoes, his hair was unkempt besides the fact that he was quite rude to other customers

- (b) Underline and name the clause elements in each of the italicized sentences in the passage (10 marks).

- (c) Draw a Table to categorise the underlined verbs in the passage as follows: (10 marks)

- (i) as either regular or irregular
- (ii) transitive or intransitive
- (iii) main verb or auxiliary verb

- (c) (i) Underline and name all the noun phrases in the first sentence of the passage (2.5mks).

- (ii) Explain the syntactic function of each noun phrase identified in (c)(i) above (21/2 marks).

2.(a) With two examples for each distinguish between attributive and predicative adjectives (5 marks).

(b) Use the following adverbs in a sentence each of your own (5 marks):

(i) carefully

(ii) on the table

(iv) Northwards

(v) Very

(c) (i) Briefly explain two main functional differences between adjectives and adverbs (5 marks).

(ii) Form adverbs from the words listed below. Use each adverb in an appropriate sentence (5 marks).

Nasty; keen, natural, attractive; tired

2. Write four (4) sentences containing one of the following items (20 marks):

a) a prepositional phrase

b) an adverb of time

c) a common noun as a direct object

d) a relative clause as a post-modifier

3. Describe the characteristics of a complex sentence. Illustrate your answer with at least four (4) examples (20 marks).

4. (a) Use the following phrase structure rules to write appropriate structures (15 marks):

(i) S-----→ NP VP

NP-----→ Detadj N PP

VP-----→ V NP

(ii) NP-----→Det N PP

(iii) S -----→ V AdvP

(iv) NP-----→PredetCentdetPostdet N S

(v)VP-----→ Aux Aux V NP

(b) Formulate a phrase structure rule for the following (5 marks)

5. The British variety of the English language should be the compulsory form of English offered in the Eastern African region. Do you agree? (20 marks).

Women of Kenya visited the Olympic village in Johannesburg last year.

AEN



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2013/2014

INSTITUTIONAL BASED PROGRAMME (APRIL 2014 SESSION)

EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF EDUCATION

AEN 101: GRAMMAR OF ENGLISH

DATE: FRIDAY 29TH AUGUST 2014

TIME: 2.00 P.M. – 4.00 P.M.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer question one and any other two questions.

Question 1 (Compulsory)

- a) Explain and illustrate the following types of pronouns in English. (10 marks)
- i) Personal pronouns
 - ii) Interrogative (wh-) pronouns
- b) Using the data given, identify and label the sentence elements listed below: (10 marks)
- A. Direct object
 - B. Indirect object
 - C. Subject complement
 - D. Object complement
 - E. Adverbial
 - i. The gave her food
 - ii. The game was played yesterday
 - iii. He looked sick
 - iv. She took the first prize
 - v. The are in the church
 - vi. The meal was very delicious
 - vii. His colleague made him their leader
 - viii. the gangster took the money away
 - ix. The chief became more corrupt with time
 - x. She played as well as she could
- c) Using two examples for each explain the following concepts in grammar:
- (i) Apposition (5 marks)
 - (ii) Antecedent (5 marks)

Question 2

Outline and illustrate the semantic, morphological and syntactic criteria that distinguish the following word classes.

- a) Nouns (10 marks)
- b) Adjectives (5 marks)
- c) Adverbs (5 marks)

Question 3

Describe the form and function of the following phrases:

- a) Verb phrase (7 marks)
- b) Prepositional phrase (6 marks)
- c) Gerund phrase (7 marks)

Question 4

Clearly explain and illustrate the following concepts:

- a) Mood (8 marks)
- b) Tense (6 marks)
- c) Aspect (8 marks)

Question 5

- a) Explain the difference between a sentence and a clause. Use an example for each to illustrate your answer. (5 marks)
- b) Sentences may be classified according to their structure and functions. Describe, the following types of Interrogatives in English, give one example sentence for each to illustrate your answer.
 - i. Yes-no Interrogatives (3 marks)
 - ii. Wh-Interrogatives (3 marks)
 - iii. Alternative questions. (3 marks)
 - iv. Tag questions (3 marks)
 - v. Rhetorical questions (3 marks)
